
EDCI 57300 Practicum Supervisors

What is the practicum supervisor position?

A practicum supervisor is generally an individual within the organization where the practicum will occur and one who is knowledgeable about the project that will be completed by the student. Generally, this person is a stake holder in the project and one that desires for the project to be successfully completed. This individual will help explain the project to the student and help monitor and report progress on the project by the student. Often the supervisor will offer information, guidance, support, and mentoring when such is needed in order to complete the project.

Who can serve as a practicum supervisor?

Generally, the supervisor is someone who works within the same organization where the project will occur. This individual knows what the project is, the goals of the project, potential relevant challenges that may need to be addressed within the organization and how those can be addressed. This individual will oversee the work on the project and monitor the progress that is being made. Examples of practicum supervisors would be: a principal/asst. principal or dept. head within a school setting where a practicum would focus on some type of instructional product design/development; a training manager in a business setting; an associate in a non-profit organization that is familiar with a specific training or evaluation project, etc.

What are the responsibilities of the practicum supervisor?

- Help identify, select, and outline potential project(s) that would be useful/valid/relevant within the organization;
- Periodically evaluate the project, the progress being made and the quality of the outcomes being achieved and offer suggestions and guidance as needed;
- Review the timeline for project completion and suggest adjustments as needed;
- Communicate (generally via email or a phone conversation) with the course instructor at the beginning and end of the project (more if needed or desired) and convey how things are progressing from the perspective of the supervisor/organization;

How is the communication between the EDCI 573 course instructor and the supervisor to be conducted?

Open communication via email or phone conversation is always promoted. At any time the supervisor sees a need to contact the course instructor, he/she is encouraged to do so. At a minimum, the course instructor will send an email to the supervisor asking for feedback on the following questions:

As the project begins:

- Have you had the opportunity to review the proposed project proposal and timeline with the student?
 - If yes, do you approve of the project?
 - If no, when will it be possible for you to review it?
- Will you serve as the supervisor for the project?

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- o If yes, please provide full contact information
 - o If no, is there another individual within the organization who will serve as the supervisor and can you provide contact information?
- What, if any, concerns do you have about the student, the selected project, or the timeline for completing the project?
- From your perspective, what can the course instructor do to help the student deliver an effective, valuable finished product?
- Do you have any questions concerning the project and what is required to complete the practicum requirements?

As the project concludes:

- In your opinion/from your perspective, to what degree have the project goals been accomplished?
- What are the strengths and weaknesses of the project as it has been completed?
- How would you rate the performance of the student as he/she completed this project? Why?